In the coming days and weeks, with the help of information provided by Balwant and his friends in the inner circle, the Indian government escalated the matter with British Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher. Bhardwaj and Jindal provided superb intelligence that completely demolished Sandhu's defences. Sandhu and five of his close associates were picked up by British security agencies. Back in India, the government released a carefully-worded statement saying that British authorities were taking action against extremists operating from London and they would hopefully be convicted soon.

But this success came with a heavy price. The R&AW spies were worried about roping in other security agencies to remove Balwant and his chosen few from the blacklist.

'You cannot involve more than two or three agencies in any espionage operation and in this case, we needed to get the state government on board. I think Balwant is testing our willingness to go beyond the textbook for peace,' Bhardwaj told Jindal.

'We also need to avert the possibility of any of them joining the gang after resettling back home,' Jindal agreed.

'We cannot afford to let them loose. We want their visit to be limited to a week. They need to return to London after talking to their people and we must ask them to persuade their friends to give up their weapons. Resettlement can be dealt with later,' Bhardwaj said.

Later, only five people including Balwant were allowed to visit India. The defector was furious and insisted that all eleven people who had worked with him to demolish Sandhu's network had to visit their homeland. Jindal might have reacted more strongly to Balwant's demand, but he had some